

Ἰωάννης ὁ Φιλόπωνος

John Philoponus of Alexandria on Aristotle and Creation

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Period: Ὀψιμαρχαία [Late Antique](#)
Dialect: Κοινή φιλοσοφική [Philosophical Koine](#)
Domain: Φιλοσοφία [Philosophy](#)
Format: Πραγματεία [Treatise](#)
Affiliation: [Christian](#)

John Philoponus was a Christian philosopher, theologian, and scholar active in Alexandria during the 6th century CE. His nickname, meaning "lover of toil," likely refers to his scholarly diligence. He studied under the Neoplatonist teacher Ammonius Hermiae, and his early career produced detailed commentaries on the works of Aristotle. Later, he became a committed Christian theologian, engaging in complex doctrinal debates of his time. His career bridges late antique Greek philosophy and early Christian intellectual culture.

His writings are broadly divided into philosophical and theological works. Major surviving texts include his extensive commentaries on Aristotle and two important treatises arguing against the idea of an eternal universe: *Against Proclus on the Eternity of the World* and *On the Creation of the World*. His theological work, the *Arbiter*, which argued for a specific Christological position, survives in Syriac translation.

John Philoponus is historically significant for his critical and innovative engagement with Aristotelian science. He proposed an early theory of "impetus" to explain projectile motion, which anticipated later medieval physics. He also forcefully argued against Aristotle's doctrine of the eternity of the world, a critique that became highly influential in later Islamic and Latin philosophical traditions. Although his unorthodox theological views led to his official condemnation as a heretic decades after his death, his philosophical works continued to be studied for centuries. He is viewed as a pivotal figure in the transition from ancient to medieval thought.

Works (11)

- Σχόλια εἰς τὰ περὶ γενέσεως ζῶων Ἀριστοτέλους · [Commentaries-Aristotle in Greek](#) · 249 passages
- Σχόλια εἰς τὰ περὶ γενέσεως καὶ φθορᾶς · [Commentary on On Generation and Corruption](#) · 314 passages
- Σχόλια εἰς τὰς κατηγορίας Ἀριστοτέλους · [Commentary on the Categories](#) · 204 passages
- Σχόλια εἰς τὰ ἀναλυτικὰ πρότερα Ἀριστοτέλους · [Commentary on the Prior Analytics](#) · 484 passages
- Σχόλια εἰς τὰ περὶ ψυχῆς Ἀριστοτέλους · [On Aristotle's Books-the Soul, Commentary](#) · 608 passages
- Σχόλια εἰς τὰ μετεωρολογικὰ Ἀριστοτέλους, · [On Aristotle's Meteorology Book I, Commentary](#) · 131 passages
- Σχόλια εἰς τὰ φυσικὰ Ἀριστοτέλους · [On Aristotle's Physics Books, Commentary](#) · 909 passages
- Σχόλια εἰς τὰ ἀναλυτικὰ ὕστερα Ἀριστοτέλους · [On Aristotle's Posterior Analytics, Commentary](#) · 440 passages
- Περὶ τῆς τοῦ κόσμου δημιουργίας · [On the Creation of the World](#) · 308 passages
- Περὶ τῆς τοῦ κόσμου αἰδιότητος · [On the Eternity of the World](#) · 639 passages

Other Christian Authors

- Αἰνείας ὁ Γαζαῖος · Aeneas of Gaza · 2 works
- Ἀνατόλιος Ἀλεξανδρεὺς · Anatolius of Alexandria · 1 work
- Ἀθηναγόρας ὁ Ἀθηναῖος · Athenagoras of Athens · 2 works
- Βούθηρος · Butherus · 1 work
- Κλήμης ὁ Ἀλεξανδρεὺς · Clement of Alexandria · 5 works
- Εὐσέβιος ὁ Καίσαρειας · Eusebius of Caesarea · 7 works
- Ἰππόλυτος ὁ Ῥωμαῖος · Hippolytus of Rome · 13 works
- Νεμέσιος ὁ Ἐμέσης · Nemesius of Emesa · 1 work
- Ὠριγένης ὁ Ἀλεξανδρεὺς · Origen of Alexandria · 25 works
- Σεντεντιῶν Σέκστου · Sententiae Sexti · 1 work
- Τατιανὸς ὁ Ἀσσύριος · Tatian the Assyrian · 1 work
- Θεοδώρητος ὁ Κύρρου · Theodoret of Cyrus · 7 works